Credit Cracks Widen

Private credit stress spreads. Oil resumes climb. S&P −1.53%. Morgan Stanley caps withdrawals. FOMC next Wednesday.

THE SESSION

Private credit stress and resurgent oil drove the S&P 500 down 1.53% to 6,671.81. The Dow fell 1.56%, the Nasdaq dropped 1.78%, and the Russell 2000 declined 2.12%. The VIX rose 12.42% to 27.24. All eleven S&P sectors finished red.

The financial sector was at the center of the selling. Morgan Stanley and Cliffwater joined BlackRock in capping fund withdrawals from private credit vehicles. JPMorgan restricted lending to private credit providers after marking down several loans. Goldman Sachs fell 3.7%, Morgan Stanley 4%. The concern is contagion — if redemption pressure forces fire sales of illiquid private loans, it could ripple into broader credit markets.

Oil resumed its climb as strikes between Iran, Israel, and GCC members intensified. Tankers continued to avoid the Strait of Hormuz. The IEA announced a release of 400 million barrels from strategic reserves, but it failed to contain the rally. Gold fell 1.65% to $5,094 as the dollar strengthened. Bitcoin held steady, up 0.25% — decoupling from the equity sell-off. February PPI arrives March 18 alongside the FOMC decision.

IOWN Tactical: S&P at ~6,672. Approaching our monitoring range but still above the –20% buy trigger (~5,800 from ATH). The dual pressure of energy inflation and financial-sector stress is the market's current challenge. Ownership discipline matters most in weeks like this.

IOWN HOLDINGS: NOTABLE MOVERS

WINNERS

CVX +2.70% GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Chevron gained as oil resumed its climb. Energy remains the only sector with consistent positive performance through the conflict.

MARA +2.46% GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Marathon rallied as Bitcoin held steady near $70,400 despite the broad equity sell-off. Crypto decoupled from risk assets today.

VLO +2.06% DIVIDEND STRATEGY

Valero added to yesterday's 5.73% gain. Refining margins continue to widen as crude holds elevated levels.

ATO +1.35% DIVIDEND STRATEGY

Atmos Energy gained as utility-adjacent names caught a defensive bid. Regulated gas distribution is insulated from the energy shock.

FTNT +1.10% GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Fortinet rose after the Stryker cyberattack news increased urgency around cybersecurity spending. Defense-related cyber demand is accelerating.

CNX +0.86% GROWTH PORTFOLIO

CNX Resources continued to benefit from elevated natural gas prices as the energy complex held firm.

BKH +0.74% DIVIDEND STRATEGY

Black Hills gained modestly. Regulated utilities provided shelter in an otherwise difficult session.

GFI +0.71% GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Gold Fields gained even as spot gold declined. The miner outperformed as gold-equity positioning remained constructive.

DECLINERS

SUPV –5.08% GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Grupo Supervielle gave back recent gains. EM financials sold off as global risk appetite contracted on the private credit stress.

TSM –5.03% GROWTH PORTFOLIO

TSMC fell over 5% as semiconductor names led the downside. Higher input costs and regulatory uncertainty weighed on the group.

STLD –4.97% DIVIDEND STRATEGY

Steel Dynamics fell nearly 5% on weakening industrial demand signals and tariff-related margin pressure.

HUT –5.05% GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Hut 8 reversed three sessions of gains. Crypto miners remain high-beta despite Bitcoin's relative stability.

ATAT –4.60% GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Atmus Filtration fell on industrial demand concerns. Rising energy costs raised input-cost fears across the manufacturing chain.

NXPI –4.33% GROWTH PORTFOLIO

NXP Semiconductors continued its slide. Auto chip demand concerns intensified as consumer spending data weakened.

LRCX –4.29% DIVIDEND STRATEGY

Lam Research reversed three sessions of gains. Semi equipment sold off with the broader tech complex.

ADI –3.74% DIVIDEND STRATEGY

Analog Devices fell with the semiconductor group. Higher yields pressure growth-oriented semi names.

HOLDINGS NEWS

Stryker cyberattack. SYK confirmed a network disruption from a cyberattack, stating it appeared contained. Shares fell 2.48%. The incident lifted cybersecurity names including our holding FTNT (+1.10%).

PORTFOLIO PERFORMANCE

DIVIDEND STRATEGY ✓ BEAT ONE

–1.42%

vs. DVY –0.38% | IWS –1.64%

GROWTH PORTFOLIO ✓ BEAT

–1.69%

vs. IUSG –1.74%

YEAR-TO-DATE

Dividend +5.46% vs DVY +6.34% / IWS +2.50%
Growth –1.42% vs IUSG –4.68%